

Personal Knowledge Map Classroom Run Kit

TOK Cognitive Science Activity Bank • Knowledge and the Knower • 20-30 min

Category	Knowledge and the Knower	Time	20-30 min
Difficulty	Medium	ID	personal-knowledge-map

Big idea: Knowers inherit knowledge from communities.

One-Minute Teacher Brief

Students identify the communities and channels that shape what they think they know.

Student Prompt

Inspect Personal Knowledge Map Stimulus A. Record one first claim, the evidence you used, your confidence, and what would make you revise.

Concrete Stimulus Packet

Personal Knowledge Map Stimulus A	Student-facing stimulus 1: A knowledge map with branches for family, school, language, algorithms, memory, and experts. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Students inspect this exact card first and commit to a claim before hearing anyone else.
Personal Knowledge Map Stimulus B	Student-facing stimulus 2: A trust colour-code showing automatic trust, earned trust, and contested trust. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Use this for comparison, a second round, or a partner challenge.
Personal Knowledge Map Reveal / Twist	Student-facing stimulus 3: A tension line between two sources that disagree about the same claim. Before discussing, write what you noticed, what you inferred, and how confident you are.	Teacher reveal: connect the changed response to the big idea — Knowers inherit knowledge from communities.

Actual Lesson Questions

#	Question for students	Teacher key / cue
1	After inspecting Personal Knowledge Map Stimulus A, what is your first knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: look for a clear claim, not just a description.
2	Which exact detail from Personal Knowledge Map Stimulus A did you use as evidence?	Teacher cue: students should name visible words, data, source features, method features, or contextual clues.
3	What did you infer beyond the evidence?	Teacher cue: this is where assumptions, framing, models, or perspective usually appear.
4	How confident are you: 50%, 60%, 70%, 80%, 90%, or 100%?	Teacher cue: confidence is data for the debrief, not a grade.
5	What missing information would most improve the knowledge claim?	Teacher cue: push for method, source, context, comparison, or definitions.
6	To what extent is personal knowledge shaped by knowledge communities?	Teacher cue: students should move from the classroom example to a general TOK issue.

Student Task

Use the stimulus cards to complete the observation/inference/evidence/confidence grid, then answer one TOK knowledge question connected to Knowledge and the Knower.

Teacher Key / Reveal

The key move is not the “right answer”; it is the moment students see how knowers inherit knowledge from communities.

- Strong response: separates observation from inference.
- Strong response: names a method, source, model, language choice, context, or perspective.
- Strong response: revises confidence when new evidence or a new criterion appears.
- Weak response: gives only opinion or says “it depends” without criteria.

Student Instructions

- Work silently for the first response so you can notice your own starting point.
- Record one knowledge claim, the evidence behind it, and your confidence level.
- After the reveal or comparison, update your claim in a different colour or column.
- Use the debrief to answer: To what extent is personal knowledge shaped by knowledge communities?

Setup Checklist

- Prepare a starter stimulus using: A knowledge map with branches for family, school, language, algorithms, memory, and experts.
- Print or project the student response grid before the activity begins.
- Plan a private first-response moment before any group discussion.

Example Stimuli or Materials

- A knowledge map with branches for family, school, language, algorithms, memory, and experts.
- A trust colour-code showing automatic trust, earned trust, and contested trust.
- A tension line between two sources that disagree about the same claim.

Resources To Use

- Resource pack: <resources/personal-knowledge-map/index.html>
- Card deck CSV: <resources/personal-knowledge-map/cards.csv>
- Visual prompt: <resources/personal-knowledge-map/visual-prompt.svg>
- Printable student worksheet with observation, inference, evidence, and confidence columns.
- Teacher notes with setup checklist, sample facilitation language, misconceptions, and assessment look-fors.
- Classroom run kit with prompt cards, example stimuli, and debrief moves.
- PowerPoint deck with a student-facing sequence for running the activity.

Run Sequence

1. Students put “my knowledge” in the centre of a page.
2. They add branches: family, school, friends, social media, culture, language, religion, books, experts, algorithms and personal experience.
3. They colour-code sources they trust most, least and automatically.
4. Pairs compare one similarity and one difference.

Debrief Moves

- Knowledge question: To what extent is personal knowledge shaped by knowledge communities?
- Are we responsible for checking inherited beliefs?
- Can a knower ever be fully independent?

Teacher Quick Script

- Write your first judgement before we discuss it; the first answer is useful evidence.
- Separate what you noticed from what you inferred.
- What would make this knowledge claim more reliable?

Exit Ticket

- One thing I first treated as evidence was...
- My confidence changed because...
- A better knowledge question I can now ask is...